

- Beginning at the end
  - 14:2 “In my Father’s house are many rooms...”
  - 20:31: “...but these are written so that you may believe...”
- Distinctives of John’s Gospel
  - Personal and intimate picture...eye-witness testimony
  - Simple but deep. Profoundly Jewish
  - Diverges from the Synoptic material, probably by design (a spiritual Gospel)
- The Prologue:
  - “In the beginning...”
  - The first week of the new creation
  - A preview of themes woven throughout the Gospel
  - The most profound theme, Jesus as the one who reveals the Father
    - ◆ No one has ever seen God...
- Jesus as Jacob’s Ladder: The first of several replacement themes
  - “A true Israelite in whom there is no deceit”
  - “You will see heaven opened, and the angels of God ascending and descending on the Son of Man.” Communion with God...reached its ultimate fulfillment in Jesus
- John’s description of miracles as “signs”
  - Their very content reveals Jesus’ Messianic character and mission
  - An integral part of a complex structure in John (see handout)
- The first sign: the wedding at Cana:
  - Deliberate extravagance
  - KoG a wedding feast. Lord will marry his people. Feasting and well-aged wine...
- The cleansing of the Temple (the second sign):
  - The people request a sign, but Jesus veils the announcement of it.
  - A Messianic cleansing
  - Jesus’ relationship to the Temple is understood against the backdrop of Jewish history
- **Jesus as Jacob’s Ladder and the replacement of the Temple are striking declarations of his divinity. He is God in our midst in a most profound and intimate way.**
- The encounter with Nicodemus
  - An unexpected response to his statement
  - Piety is useless in itself. The whole man must be replaced.
- The Woman at the Well
  - Since the Temple has been replaced, how must we worship now in the new age?
  - Both cultural centers will be superseded, and indeed it has already begun
  - Spirit and Truth (the key verse)
    - ◆ Spirit: Not simple, immaterial worship, but the creative power of God
    - ◆ Truth: The revelation of God in Christ. The Messiah has come to his Temple
  - A redemptive-historical contrast
- Healing on the Sabbath
  - “My Father is always working, and so am I”